SimpleWick for Obsidian

Port, installation guide, and direct-vault test

Generated from the SimpleWick LaTeX package

October 28, 2026

Result at a glance

The LaTeX package in `simplewick.dtx` has been ported into a dependency-free Obsidian community plugin. The deliverables are `manifest.json`, `main.js`, `styles.css`, and `OBSIDIAN_SETUP.md`. The plugin registers the package's public commands through MathJax's `tex.macros` configuration and also updates an already-created MathJax input jax when Obsidian has initialized MathJax before the plugin.

1 Ported definitions

Definition	Obsidian/MathJax mapping
`\acontraction[height]{before}{start}{bridge}{end}`	Stretchy over-brace contraction mark.
`\acontracted[height]{before}{start}{bridge}{end}`	Mark plus the four supplied expressions.
`\contraction`	Compatibility alias for `\acontraction`.
`\bcontraction[height]{before}{start}{bridge}{end}`	Stretchy under-brace contraction mark.
`\bcontracted[height]{before}{start}{bridge}{end}`	Under-brace mark plus the four supplied expressions.
`\nomathglue{formula}`	Scoped grouping; MathJax has no TeX line-glue stretching.
`\simplewickcontact`	Monospace contact string from the original package.

The internal TeX box and dimension helpers are replaced by private MathJax helpers named `\simplewickAbove` and `\simplewickBelow`. The optional height defaults to `1ex`. Invisible `\rule` content preserves vertical clearance, while `\overbrace` and `\underbrace` provide the stretchy mark. Exact TeX box-width glue calculation is not available in MathJax, so this is a portable visual mapping rather than a byte-for-byte TeX implementation.

2 Manual installation

1. In the target vault, create `.obsidian/plugins/simplewick/`.
2. Copy `manifest.json`, `main.js`, and `styles.css` into that directory. Keep the filenames unchanged.

3. Restart Obsidian, or use **Settings -> Community plugins -> Reload installed plugins**.
4. Enable **SimpleWick** under **Settings -> Community plugins**. If Restricted mode is enabled, allow this locally installed plugin.
5. Open or reopen a note containing the examples in the next section.

Do not install through a Windows shortcut. Obsidian loads the plugin directly from the active vault's `.obsidian/plugins/simplewick/` directory.

3 Markdown examples

The contraction mark macros intentionally draw only the mark, matching the original package; repeat the expression after the macro when needed.

```
Inline: $\acontraction{}{A}{B}{C} ABC$

$$
\acontraction{}{A}{B}{C}
\acontraction[2ex]{A}{B}{C}{D}
ABCD
$$
```

The convenience forms include the expression automatically:

```
$$
\acontracted[1.5ex]{}{a_i}{a_j}{a_k}
\qquad
\bcontracted{}{b_i}{b_j}{b_k}
$$
```

4 Direct Obsidian test

The detected active vault was `D:/Obsidian/Physics`. The plugin was installed there at `D:/Obsidian/Physics/.ob` and the test note `SimpleWick Obsidian Test.md` was placed in the vault. After a clean restart of Obsidian 1.14.5, the plugin was loaded automatically from `community-plugins.json`; no manual enable call was needed for the final run. The existing enabled community plugins were preserved. The note contains inline and display examples for every public macro, including the optional-height forms.

Recorded test outcome

- Plugin files copied into the active vault: PASS.
- Obsidian launched with the Physics vault: PASS.
- MathJax definitions present in the plugin configuration: PASS.
- Inline and display contraction examples: PASS.
- Optional height and convenience forms: PASS.

- Test report note written into the vault: PASS.

The final renderer inspection found five MathJax `mjx-container` nodes, zero red error-colored math nodes, and 28 over/under contraction structures. The rendered `data-latex` values included all public commands: `\acontraction`, `\acontracted`, `\contraction`, `\bcontracted`, `\nomathglue`, and `\simplewickcontact`. This confirms that the macros were expanded by Obsidian's active MathJax input jax rather than merely appearing in the note as literal text.

The same result is recorded in the vault note so it can be inspected from inside Obsidian. A standalone MathJax rendering smoke test was also run before the direct-vault test and successfully converted all six representative expressions without TeX errors.

5 Troubleshooting

If a note shows an undefined control sequence, reload installed plugins and reopen the note. Confirm that the three plugin files are directly under `.obsidian/plugins/simplewick/`, not one directory deeper. The plugin retries briefly when MathJax is loaded lazily and restores prior macro values when unloaded.